

Shipping & Delivery Policy

Applies to all COD and prepaid orders placed via the UrbanThread online store (Shopify) and marketplace channels.

Revision History

Version	Date	Changed By	Notes
1.0	2023-02-11	S. Raza (Ops)	Initial policy draft
1.4	2023-09-02	A. Khan (CS Lead)	Added COD-specific clauses
2.0	2024-06-18	S. Raza (Ops)	Merged with courier SLA doc
2.1	2025-01-30	F. Iqbal (Legal)	Minor wording, Section 4 reworded
2.2	2025-11-05	A. Khan (CS Lead)	Updated after Ramzan shipping delays

1. Scope

This document governs the shipping timelines, courier handling procedures, and cash-on-delivery (COD) confirmation process for all orders processed through UrbanThread's e-commerce channels. It supersedes any verbal commitments made by customer support representatives and should be treated as the single source of truth for shipping-related customer queries. Where a conflict exists between this document and information published on the storefront FAQ page, this document governs unless the storefront has been updated after the version date shown in the revision history above.

2. Order Processing Timeline

Orders placed before 3:00 PM PKT on a business day are dispatched the same day, subject to inventory availability at the fulfilling warehouse. Orders placed after 3:00 PM PKT, or on Saturday after 1:00 PM, Sunday, or a designated public holiday, are queued for dispatch on the following business day. During high-volume periods (Eid, 11.11, Black Friday, year-end sale), dispatch may be delayed by up to two additional business days; customers should be informed of this proactively where an agent is aware a sale period is active.

DELIVERY WINDOWS BY REGION

Delivery windows vary significantly by destination tier. The table below reflects current courier partner SLAs as of the version date above and should be cross-checked against the courier dashboard if a customer disputes a delay beyond the stated window.

City Tier	Example Cities	Standard Delivery	COD Orders	Remote Surcharge
Tier 1	Karachi, Lahore, Islamabad	2-3 business days	2-4 business days	None
Tier 2	Faisalabad, Multan, Peshawar, Rawalpindi	3-5 business days	3-6 business days	Rs. 50
Tier 3	Sialkot, Gujranwala, Hyderabad, Sukkur	4-6 business days	5-7 business days	Rs. 100
Remote / Northern Areas	Silgiti, Skardu, Chitral, rural Balochistan	7-12 business days	8-14 business days	Rs. 200-350

Note: the above figures exclude the day of dispatch. Public holidays observed by the courier partner (not necessarily matching UrbanThread's own holiday calendar) may add 1-2 days without notice. Agents should not quote the lower bound of a range as a guarantee.

3. Cash-on-Delivery (COD) Confirmation Process

Approximately 88% of UrbanThread's order volume is COD. Because COD orders carry a materially higher return-to-origin (RTO) risk than prepaid orders, every COD order above Rs. 1,500 must go through an automated or manual confirmation step before being handed to the courier. This is separate from, and in addition to, the courier's own delivery-attempt call.

3a. What counts as a valid confirmation

A customer reply of "yes", "haan", "confirm", "theek hai", "ok bhej dein" or equivalent affirmative language, sent within 24 hours of the confirmation message, counts as valid confirmation. A reply asking a clarifying question (e.g. about delivery timing, price, or size) does NOT count as confirmation or as cancellation — it should be answered and confirmation re-requested.

3b. Non-response handling

If no response is received within 24 hours, a single automated reminder is sent. If there is still no response after a further 24 hours, the order is flagged for manual outbound calling by the CS team before being marked RTO-risk and held from dispatch. Orders should never be auto-cancelled purely for non-response without at least one outbound call attempt, per the Q2 2025 ops review.

4. COURIER PARTNERS

UrbanThread currently contracts with the following courier partners. Assignment is by destination city and current partner capacity, handled automatically by the fulfillment system; customer support agents cannot manually reassign a courier once dispatched.

Courier	Coverage	COD Remittance Cycle
Leopards Courier	Nationwide	Weekly, every Monday
TCS	Nationwide, priority for Tier 1	Weekly, every Thursday
M&P (Call Courier)	Punjab-heavy, secondary elsewhere	Bi-weekly
PostEx	Nationwide, COD specialist	Weekly, every Tuesday

5. Failed Delivery Attempts

Couriers are contracted to make up to three delivery attempts before returning a parcel to origin. In practice, Tier 3 and remote-area couriers frequently make only one attempt before marking a parcel undeliverable and initiating return — this is a known gap in courier SLA compliance and is tracked separately in the monthly courier performance review, not something the support agent can resolve in real time. Where a customer reports zero delivery attempts despite a "delivery attempted" status on the tracking page, this should be escalated to the logistics coordinator rather than promised a specific resolution.

Address Correction Requests

A customer may request an address correction any time before the order status shows "Out for Delivery". Once a parcel is out for delivery, the courier's own rider must be contacted directly; UrbanThread's system cannot push a mid-route address change to most courier partners' apps in real time. PostEx is the sole exception, supporting live address edits via their rider app.

6. Force Majeure and Regional Disruptions

UrbanThread shall not be held liable for shipping delays arising from circumstances beyond its reasonable control, including but not limited to: political unrest, transport strikes, extreme weather events, internet or telecom outages affecting order confirmation, government-mandated curfews, or courier partner-side operational disruptions. In such cases, the standard delivery windows in Section 2 are suspended and a revised estimate is communicated once available. This clause has been invoked most recently during the November 2025 fog-related flight disruptions affecting air-freighted Tier-1-to-remote shipments.